peaceful and friendly relations among nations based on respect for the principle of equal rights and self-determination of peoples, the United Nations shall promote:

- Higher standards of living, full employment, and conditions of economic and social progress and development.
- Solutions of international economic, social, health and related problems; and international cultural and educational cooperation.
- Universal respect for, and observance of, human rights and fundamental freedoms for all without distinction as to race, sex, language or religion.

Thus, the UN Charter contains provisions that are noble and lofty but their realization is mostly circumscribed by the oligarchic and hegemonic structure of the UN as reflected in the composition of the Security Council and the preponderance of the P-5.

Membership

Chapter II (Articles 3, 4, 5 and 6) embodies the principle relating to the acquisition and revocation of membership of the UN. Article 3 enunciates that the original members of the UN are those states which, “having participated in the United Nations Conference on International Organization at San Francisco, or having previously signed the Declaration by United Nations on 1 January 1942, sign the present Charter and ratify it” in accordance with their respective constitutional process.

Article 4 states that the membership of the United Nations is open to “all other peace-loving states which accept the obligations contained in the present Charter and, in the judgment of the Organization, are able and willing to carry out these obligations” and the admission of any such state to membership of the United Nations will be effected by a decision of the General Assembly upon the recommendation of the Security Council.

Article 5 contains provisions regarding suspension of exercise of rights and privileges of membership, against whom preventive or